
Stillwater Area Public Schools

Independent School District No. 834 • Washington County, Minnesota

Financial Summary

Audited FY2024–25 Results & FY2025–26 Adopted Budget

8,223

Students served
(2024–25)

\$155.9M

General Fund
expenditures (FY25)

\$18,749

Operating cost
per ADM (FY25)

\$6.29M

General Fund
balance (6/30/25)

\$167.3M

Long-term debt
outstanding

Stillwater Area Public Schools serves nearly 8,400 students and more than 60,000 residents across Washington County on an annual operating budget of roughly \$100 million. This summary consolidates the district's most recent audited financial statements (fiscal year ended June 30, 2025) with the officially published district-wide budget for FY2025–26. The FY2024–25 audit received an unmodified (“clean”) opinion from independent auditors LB Carlson, LLP.

Prepared July 1, 2026. All figures sourced from official district and audited documents; see final page for sources.

1. District-Wide Budget & Fund Balances (All Funds)

The table below is drawn from the district's statutory budget publication (MDE Form ED-00110-48), reporting FY2025 audited actuals alongside the FY2026 adopted budget for every fund. Fund balances carry forward from the prior year end.

Fund	Begin. Bal. 7/1/24	FY25 Revenue	FY25 Expend.	Bal. 6/30/25	FY26 Rev. Budget	FY26 Exp. Budget	Proj. Bal. 6/30/26
General Fund – Restricted	\$3,873,149	\$20,963,880	\$21,413,705	\$3,423,324	\$21,281,910	\$21,567,825	\$3,137,409
General Fund – Other	\$4,072,577	\$133,255,713	\$134,462,740	\$2,865,550	\$132,092,067	\$131,806,152	\$3,151,465
Food Service	\$3,774,272	\$7,889,589	\$7,439,615	\$4,224,246	\$7,887,103	\$7,859,232	\$4,252,117
Community Service	\$571,694	\$9,413,555	\$9,254,026	\$731,223	\$9,595,953	\$9,284,092	\$1,043,084
Building Construction	\$113,257,585	\$5,076,246	\$37,167,142	\$81,166,689	\$80,545,000	\$125,140,042	\$36,571,647
Debt Service	\$2,613,340	\$17,325,690	\$16,748,820	\$3,190,210	\$18,551,334	\$17,509,221	\$4,232,323
Internal Service	\$1,384,815	\$21,694,789	\$23,079,142	\$462	\$23,820,000	\$23,820,000	\$462
OPEB Irrevocable Trust	\$4,418,741	\$274,225	\$406,916	\$4,286,050	\$0	\$0	\$4,286,050
Total – All Funds	\$133,966,173	\$215,893,687	\$249,972,106	\$99,887,754	\$293,773,367	\$336,986,564	\$56,674,557

Reading the numbers: Total all-funds expenditures jump from \$250.0M (FY25) to a budgeted \$337.0M (FY26) almost entirely because of the Building Construction Fund, which spends down 2023-authorized bond proceeds (\$125.1M budgeted) on the Andersen and Lake Elmo elementary replacements, the Oak-Land Middle School expansion, and district-wide safety/security work. Excluding construction, operations are roughly balanced.

2. General Fund Detail (Audited FY2024–25)

The General Fund is the district's primary operating fund. In FY25 it ran an operating deficit: revenues of \$153.78M against expenditures of \$155.88M, a net change in fund balance of –\$1.66M (a further \$0.89M reduction came from a prior-period accounting correction reclassified to the Capital Projects Fund).

Revenue by Source

Source	Amount	% of Total
State sources	\$101,478,487	66.0%
Property taxes (local)	\$44,481,414	28.9%
Other local	\$4,381,163	2.8%
Federal sources	\$2,732,937	1.8%
Investment earnings	\$703,027	0.5%
Total revenue	\$153,777,028	100%

Expenditures by Program

Program	Amount
Regular instruction (elem & secondary)	\$59,379,595
Special education instruction	\$29,456,376
Pupil support services	\$20,316,419
Sites and buildings	\$19,075,205
Instructional support services	\$10,314,372
District support services	\$7,603,656
Administration	\$4,086,910
Vocational education	\$2,240,103
Debt service (principal & interest)	\$2,137,747
Fiscal & other fixed costs	\$1,037,453
Community service	\$229,788
Total expenditures	\$155,877,624

3. General Fund Budget-to-Actual (FY2024–25)

	Original Budget	Final Budget	Actual	Variance vs. Final
Total revenue	\$149,339,352	\$152,032,543	\$153,777,028	\$1,744,485
Total expenditures	\$150,186,343	\$152,008,935	\$155,877,624	\$(3,868,689)
Other financing sources	\$312	\$11,600	\$443,742	\$432,142
Net change in fund balance	\$(846,679)	\$35,208	\$(1,656,854)	\$(1,692,062)

Actual revenue came in \$1.74M (1.1%) above the final budget, led by stronger state aid and investment earnings. Expenditures finished \$3.87M (2.5%) over budget, driven by transportation and special-education overruns and planned use of restricted reserves for a wireless-network capital project.

General Fund Balance Composition (6/30/2025)

Classification	Amount
Restricted	\$4,110,199
Assigned	\$1,161,299
Unassigned	\$956,846
Nonspendable	\$60,527
Total fund balance	\$6,288,871

Reserve watch: Unassigned fund balance equaled about 1.1% of General Fund expenditures at year end — well below the School Board's policy target of a 5.0% **minimum**. This is the district's key financial-health pressure point and the backdrop for its Priority-Based Budgeting process.

Government-Wide Position & Long-Term Debt

Metric	Value
Total net position, governmental activities (6/30/25)	\$28.01M
Change in net position from operations (FY25)	+\$14.76M
General obligation bonds outstanding (6/30/25)	\$158.99M
Certificates of participation outstanding	\$8.29M
Total long-term debt outstanding (bonds + COPs)	\$167.28M
Total long-term liabilities (incl. pension/OPEB/leave)	\$281.53M
Authorized-but-unissued bonds (2023 referendum)	up to \$74.85M

4. Key Takeaways

- **Clean audit, but thin operating reserves.** The FY25 statements earned an unmodified opinion, yet the General Fund's unassigned reserve sits near 1.1% of expenditures versus a 5% policy floor.
- **Operating deficit in the General Fund.** FY25 spending exceeded revenue by ~\$2.1M before financing sources; the fund balance fell from \$7.95M (restated) to \$6.29M.
- **State aid dominates revenue.** About 66% of General Fund revenue is state formula aid and 29% is local property tax, so enrollment and legislative funding drive the budget. FY26 adds \$200/pupil (+2.75%).
- **Capital program is the big mover.** A \$174.8M 2023 bond authorization (first \$100M issued Feb 2024) is being spent on school replacements and safety upgrades, which is why all-funds spending balloons in FY26.
- **Cost pressures continue.** Special education, transportation, pension/benefit changes and inflation pushed FY25 expenditures 2.5% over budget, prompting Priority-Based Budgeting adjustments for FY27.

Enrollment & Per-Pupil Cost

Students served (2024–25): **8,223** • Total ADM (FY25): **8,267.77** • Total operating expenditures: **\$155,013,138**

- Operating cost per ADM: **\$18,749.09**

Sources

- Stillwater Area Public Schools — ACFR, fiscal year ended June 30, 2025 (audited by LB Carlson, LLP): government-wide statements, governmental-fund statements, General Fund budget-to-actual, and MD&A.
- Minnesota Dept. of Education Form ED-00110-48, "District Revenues and Expenditures — Budget for FY2025 and FY2026" (Budget Publication, data as of 11/17/2025).
- Stillwater Area Public Schools Business & Finance department page (stillwaterschools.org).
- District Board of Education agenda, business meeting of May 19, 2026 (BoardBook), including the FY26 Spring Budget Revision item.

Note: The May 19, 2026 board packet's FY26 Spring Budget Revision presentation is published as an image-based file that could not be machine-read; the FY26 figures shown here reflect the district's official published budget (data as of Nov. 17, 2025). Minor differences between the ACFR and the statutory publication reflect the treatment of interfund transfers. Prepared for informational purposes; not an official district document.